LARKSPUR & CO.

A CALM, STEP-BY-STEP MOVING PLANNER

The Moving House Planner

An 8-week countdown, budget, packing and box log, a UK change of address checklist, moving day plan, first night box and settling-in pages.

21 pages | UK friendly | Print at home



Works for buying or renting, big moves or small.

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START HERE

Moving, without the meltdown

Moving house is one of life's most stressful jobs: hundreds of tasks, deadlines, boxes and people to tell. This planner breaks it into small weekly steps and keeps every detail in one place.

INSIDE

- [ ] Moving overview and key contacts
- [ ] 8-week countdown, week by week
- [ ] Budget and removals quotes
- [ ] Declutter plan
- [ ] Packing room by room and a box log
- [ ] Change of address checklist (UK)
- [ ] Utilities and meter readings
- [ ] Moving day plan and first night box
- [ ] New home cleaning and settling in

GOOD TO KNOW

- [ ] Undated, so it works for any move
- [ ] Works for buying or renting
- [ ] Tick off what applies to you
- [ ] Keep it in a folder with your paperwork
- [ ] Moving with kids or pets? There's a page for that

NOTES

THE BASICS

Moving overview

Everything about the move on one page.

MOVING FROM

Address _____

Postcode _____

Keys handed back by _____

MOVING TO

Address _____

Postcode _____

Keys collected from _____

DATES

Moving day _____

Completion / tenancy start _____

Removals booked for _____

Time off work _____

KEY CONTACTS

Solicitor / conveyancer _____

Estate / letting agent _____

Removals company _____

Landlord / seller _____

NOTES

THE COUNTDOWN

8 weeks to go

Week of _____

Plan, sort and book the big things.

TO DO

- [ ] Set a moving budget
- [ ] Get 3 removals quotes (or price up a van)
- [ ] Start decluttering one room at a time
- [ ] Check notice periods (tenancy, broadband, contracts)
- [ ] Collect free boxes, buy tape and markers
- [ ] Make a floor plan of the new place if you can
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

CALLS & EMAILS

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

BUY

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

NOTES

THE COUNTDOWN

6 weeks to go

Week of _____

Book, notify and start packing the things you rarely use.

TO DO

- [ ] Book removals or van hire
- [ ] Give notice to your landlord if renting
- [ ] Book time off work for moving day
- [ ] Start packing books, decorations, out-of-season clothes
- [ ] Arrange childcare or pet care for moving day
- [ ] Use up freezer and cupboard food
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

CALLS & EMAILS

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

BUY

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

NOTES

THE COUNTDOWN

4 weeks to go

Week of _____

Start telling people and arranging services.

TO DO

- [ ] Set up Royal Mail redirection
- [ ] Arrange broadband at the new address (installs can take weeks)
- [ ] Notify energy and water suppliers of your move date
- [ ] Start the change of address checklist
- [ ] Book any cleaning for the old place
- [ ] Keep packing: one room at a time
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

CALLS & EMAILS

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

BUY

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

NOTES

THE COUNTDOWN

2 weeks to go

Week of _____

Confirm everything and pack most of the house.

TO DO

- [ ] Confirm removals date and time
- [ ] Confirm key collection arrangements
- [ ] Pack everything except essentials
- [ ] Sort parking for the removal van (both addresses)
- [ ] Return library books, collect dry cleaning
- [ ] Defrost freezer plan
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

CALLS & EMAILS

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

BUY

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

NOTES

THE COUNTDOWN

Moving week

Week of _____

Final packing, first night box, and rest where you can.

TO DO

- [ ] Pack the first night box
- [ ] Pack a bag of essentials for each person
- [ ] Charge phones and power banks
- [ ] Take meter photos at the old place on moving day
- [ ] Clean the old place (or book a cleaner)
- [ ] Label every box with room and contents
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

CALLS & EMAILS

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

BUY

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

NOTES

MONEY

Moving budget

Moving costs add up fast. Track them all here.

COST	ESTIMATE £	ACTUAL £	PAID
Removals / van hire			
Packing materials			
Solicitor / conveyancing			
Stamp duty / LBTT / LTT			
Surveys			
Deposit / first month's rent			
Cleaning			
Storage			
Time off work			
Takeaways & snacks			
New furniture & essentials			
Total			

Property taxes differ across the UK: Stamp Duty in England and Northern Ireland, LBTT in Scotland and LTT in Wales.

NOTES

MONEY

Removals quotes

Get at least three quotes and compare like for like.

QUOTE 1

Company _____

Contact _____

Price £ _____

Packing included? _____

Insurance cover _____

Date available _____

Reviews _____

Deposit _____

Rating ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

QUOTE 2

Company _____

Contact _____

Price £ _____

Packing included? _____

Insurance cover _____

Date available _____

Reviews _____

Deposit _____

Rating ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

QUOTE 3

Company _____

Contact _____

Price £ _____

Packing included? _____

Insurance cover _____

Date available _____

Reviews _____

Deposit _____

Rating ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

DECISION & NOTES

DECLUTTER

Declutter plan

Every item you don't move is one less to pack, carry and unpack.

ROOM	KEEP	SELL	DONATE	BIN / RECYCLE	DONE
Kitchen					
Living room					
Bedroom 1					
Bedroom 2					
Bathroom					
Hall & cupboards					
Loft / garage					
Garden / shed					

THINGS TO SELL (AND WHERE)

PACKING

Packing tips & supplies

SUPPLIES

- [ ] Boxes (small for heavy, large for light)
- [ ] Strong packing tape
- [ ] Thick marker pens
- [ ] Bubble wrap or newspaper
- [ ] Coloured stickers for each room
- [ ] Mattress bags
- [ ] Furniture blankets

PACKING TIPS

- [ ] Heavy items in small boxes
- [ ] Label the top AND side of each box
- [ ] Write the room and a short contents list
- [ ] Number every box and log it
- [ ] Pack a box per room of "open first" things
- [ ] Take photos of cable setups before unplugging

PACK LAST

- [ ] Kettle, mugs, tea and coffee
- [ ] Toilet roll
- [ ] Phone chargers
- [ ] Medication
- [ ] Bedding for the first night

DON'T PACK

- [ ] Passports and important documents
- [ ] Keys
- [ ] Jewellery and valuables
- [ ] Laptop
- [ ] Bank cards

NOTES

PACKING

Box log

Number every box. If one goes missing, you'll know exactly what's in it.

BOX #	ROOM	CONTENTS	FRAGILE	ARRIVED

ADMIN

Change of address checklist (UK)

Tick off who you've told. Many can be updated online.

GOVERNMENT

- [ ] Council tax (old and new council)
- [ ] Electoral register
- [ ] DVLA: driving licence (the law says you must update it)
- [ ] DVLA: vehicle log book (V5C)
- [ ] HMRC
- [ ] DWP / benefits
- [ ] TV Licensing
- [ ] Passport (if needed)

MONEY

- [ ] Bank and building society
- [ ] Credit cards
- [ ] Loans and finance
- [ ] Pension providers
- [ ] Premium Bonds / savings
- [ ] Investments

HOME & INSURANCE

- [ ] Home or contents insurance
- [ ] Car insurance
- [ ] Pet insurance
- [ ] Life insurance
- [ ] Breakdown cover
- [ ] Royal Mail redirection

HEALTH & WORK

- [ ] GP surgery
- [ ] Dentist
- [ ] Opticians
- [ ] Employer
- [ ] School / nursery
- [ ] Vet

EVERYTHING ELSE

- [ ] Mobile phone
- [ ] Broadband
- [ ] Online shopping accounts
- [ ] Subscriptions & deliveries
- [ ] Gym and clubs
- [ ] Friends and family

NOTES

ADMIN

Utilities & meter readings

Take photos of every meter on moving day, at both properties.

OLD HOME

SERVICE	SUPPLIER	FINAL READING	CLOSED
Electricity			
Gas			
Water			
Broadband			
TV / streaming			

NEW HOME

SERVICE	SUPPLIER	FIRST READING	SET UP
Electricity			
Gas			
Water			
Broadband			
TV / streaming			

WHERE THINGS ARE IN THE NEW HOME

Stopcock _____

Fuse box _____

Gas meter _____

Electric meter _____

Boiler _____

Bins & collection day _____

NOTES

MOVING DAY

Moving day plan

Write the plan down so nobody has to hold it in their head.

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS	WHO

LEAVING THE OLD HOME

- [ ] Meter photos taken
- [ ] Every cupboard and room checked
- [ ] Windows locked, lights off
- [ ] Keys handed over

ARRIVING

- [ ] Meter photos taken
- [ ] Check for damage
- [ ] Beds built first
- [ ] Kettle on!

NOTES

MOVING DAY

First night box

One clearly labelled box (or bag) that travels with you, not in the van.

KITCHEN

- [ ] Kettle
- [ ] Mugs, tea, coffee, milk
- [ ] Snacks and easy food
- [ ] Plates and cutlery
- [ ] Washing-up liquid and cloth
- [ ] Bin bags

BEDROOM & BATHROOM

- [ ] Bedding and pillows
- [ ] Pyjamas and change of clothes
- [ ] Toilet roll
- [ ] Towels
- [ ] Toothbrushes and toiletries
- [ ] Medication

TOOLKIT

- [ ] Phone chargers
- [ ] Scissors or box cutter
- [ ] Screwdriver and Allen keys
- [ ] Torch
- [ ] Light bulbs
- [ ] Extension lead

KIDS & PETS

- [ ] Favourite toys and comforters
- [ ] Night light
- [ ] Pet food, bowls and bedding
- [ ] Litter tray

NOTES

NEW HOME

New home cleaning checklist

Ideally before the boxes come in.

KITCHEN

- [ ] Inside cupboards
- [ ] Fridge and freezer
- [ ] Oven and hob
- [ ] Sink and taps
- [ ] Worktops
- [ ] Floors

BATHROOM

- [ ] Toilet
- [ ] Bath and shower
- [ ] Sink and taps
- [ ] Mirror
- [ ] Cabinets
- [ ] Floor

EVERY ROOM

- [ ] Skirting boards
- [ ] Light switches and handles
- [ ] Windows and sills
- [ ] Wardrobes inside
- [ ] Carpets hoovered
- [ ] Change the locks (if buying)

SAFETY

- [ ] Test smoke alarms
- [ ] Test carbon monoxide alarm
- [ ] Find the stopcock
- [ ] Find the fuse box
- [ ] Check window locks

NOTES

NEW HOME

Settling in

Unpack one room at a time: bedrooms and kitchen first.

ROOM	UNPACKED	ORGANISED	TO BUY
Kitchen			
Bedroom 1			
Bedroom 2			
Bathroom			
Living room			
Hall			
Garden			

LOCAL THINGS TO FIND

Supermarket _____

GP surgery _____

Pharmacy _____

Takeaway _____

Park / walks _____

Recycling centre _____

NEIGHBOURS' NAMES

FAMILY

Moving with kids & pets

Change is hard for little ones and animals too. A bit of planning helps everyone settle.

Talk early

Tell children what's happening, look at photos of the new home, and let them choose something for their new room.

Keep routines

Keep meals and bedtimes as normal as possible in the weeks around the move.

Unpack their room first

Familiar bedding, toys and night lights help kids feel safe on the first night.

Pets on moving day

Keep pets in a quiet room with the door shut, or with a friend, so they can't slip out.

Cats

Keep cats indoors for a few weeks in the new home so they can settle before going outside.

Update microchips

Update your pet's microchip details with your new address straight away.

NOTES

ADMIN

Useful contacts

WHO	NAME	PHONE	EMAIL / REFERENCE

NOTES